

Step 2 : Determine the supporting technology elements necessary to create a fully functional (working) product.

For the "Think Jet" printer, the supporting tech. elements include :

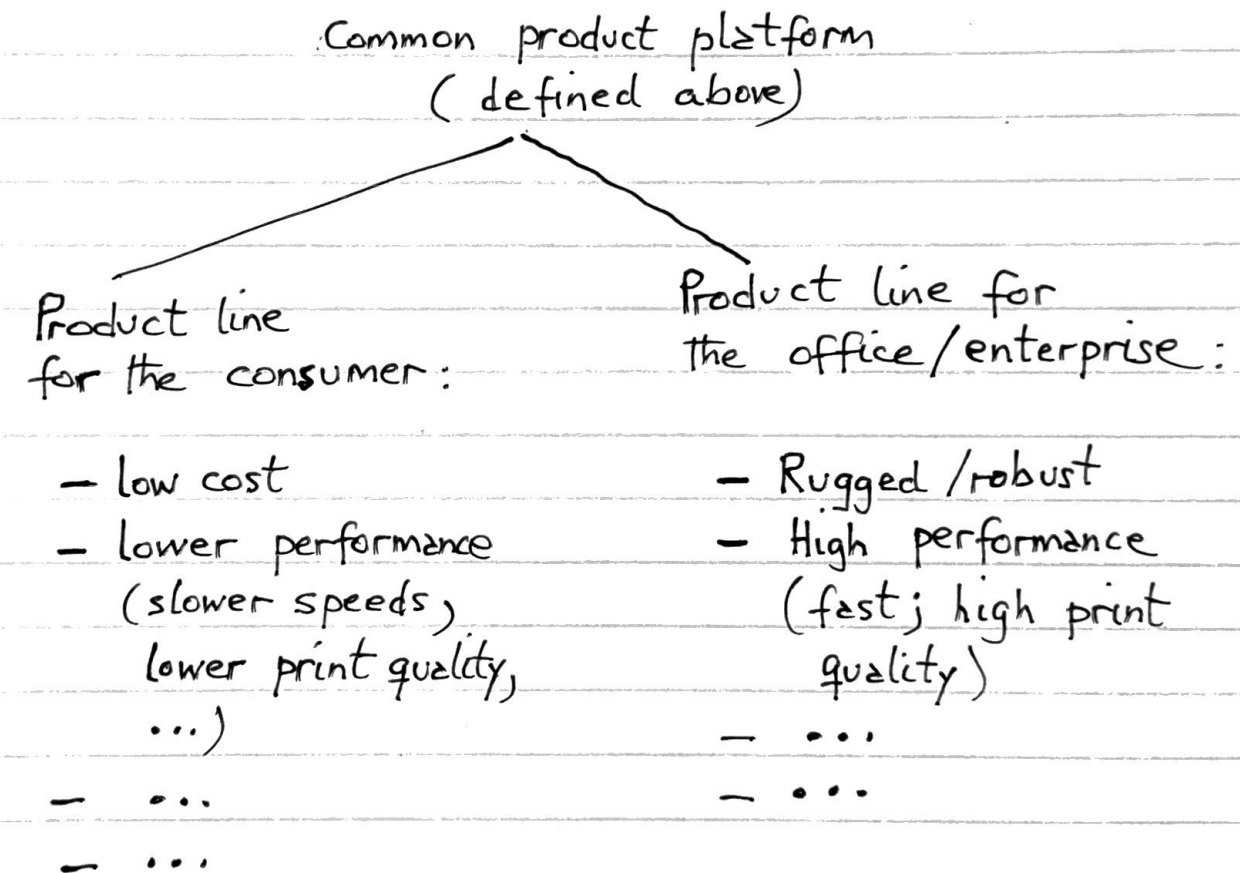
- print-head (to hold & support a row of nozzles)
- Interconnect cable (to connect the print-head to the motor/drive electronics)
- Drive electronics/software (to control the printing of dots on paper)
- ...
- ...

Definition : The product platform is the combination of the core (or defining) & supporting technology elements.

Product platform $\equiv$ (Core + Supporting) tech. elements
Infrastructure

Step 3 : For each target market segments, use the product platform to create a product line to serve that particular market segment.

Example : Think Jet platform + product lines :



both these product lines are based on the same product platform (from steps 1, 2)

Example : Personal computer product platform
($\approx$ mid 1980s - early '90s)

IBM Product Platform

- MS DOS OS
 - Intel 8086/8088 "chip"
- core or defining elements

"open-source" or
"horizontal" platform

very successful in
obtaining a large
market share

(because of the
"network" effect)

⇒ Differentiated strategy

⇒ Easy to clone

by Dell, Compaq

Cost Leadership

Apple Product Platform

- Proprietary (or
Graphic User Interface)
OS
 - Motorola 68000 chip
- core or defining elements

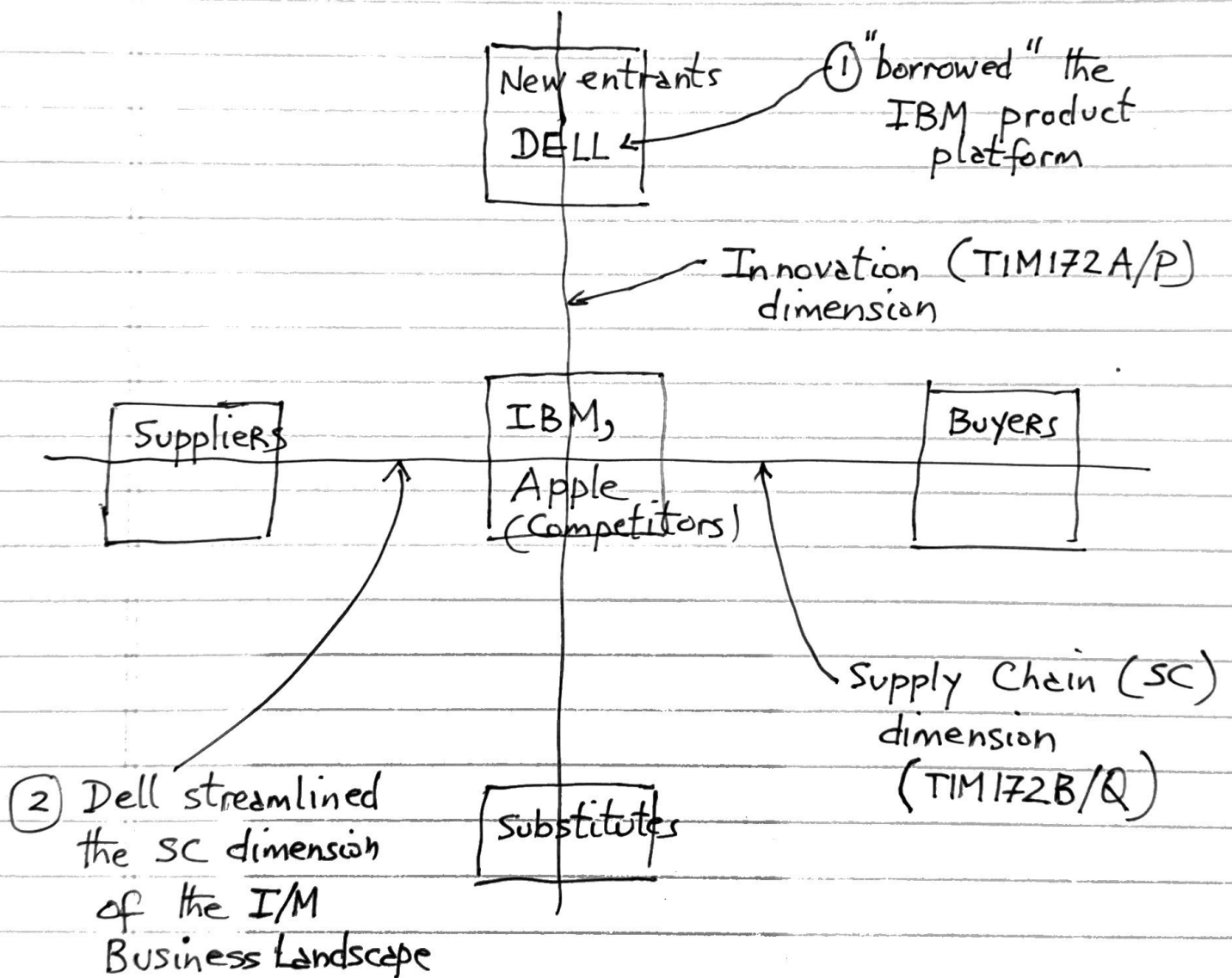
"proprietary"
or "vertical" platform

fairly successful,
sustainable, but
does not succeed
in gaining market
share

⇒ Focus strategy

How DELL captured the PC market in the 1990 & 2000s

PC Business Landscape ($\approx$ 1980s)



Cost Leader $\Rightarrow$ capture/grow market share

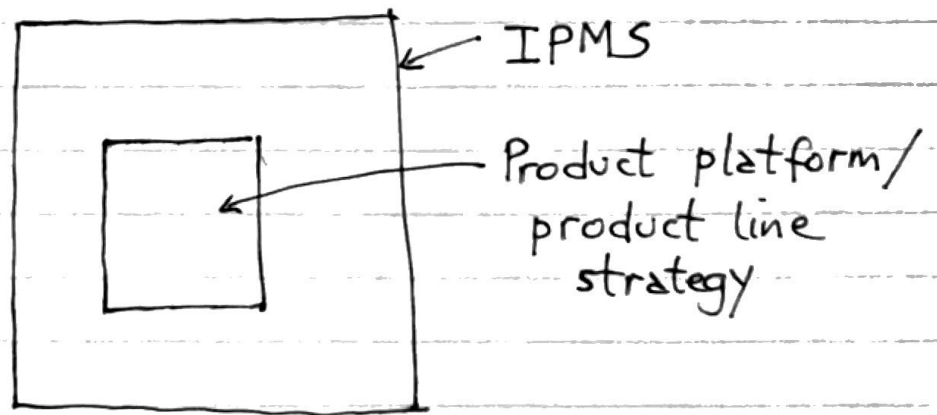
Downside: business (as opposed to innovation) model $\Rightarrow$ not sustainable.

TIM 172 A, Lecture # 16 (11/20/25)

Agenda

1. Product architecture: product platform & product lines
(done; see above) (with examples)
2. Integrated product (management) strategy
- Intel / Apple example
3. HW # 8 (final homework set) has been posted & due on the last day of class
4. Financial modeling

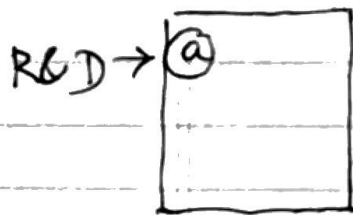
2. Integrated Product Management Strategy (IPMS)



Process for creating an IPMS :

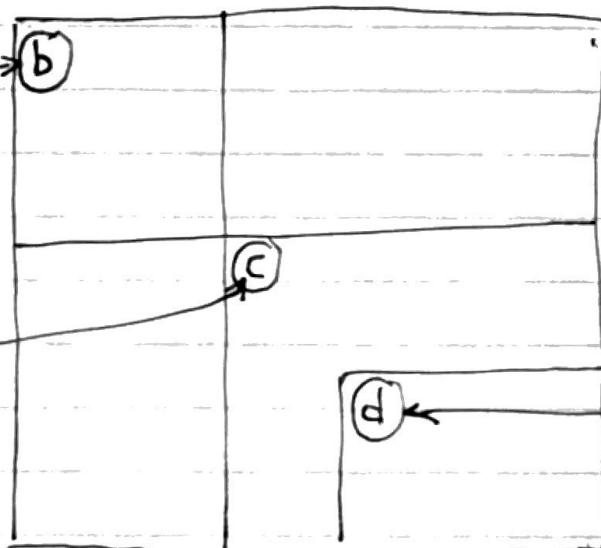
- Step 1 : Establish (or define) the underlying elements of the product platform
- core tech. elements
 - supporting tech elements

How are the core & supporting tech elements related to the Aggregate Project Plan (APP)?



break-through product → (b)

platform product → (c)



increments, derivatives



core & supporting elements for the product platform

product lines

Product platform
 infrastructure
 tech. elements {
 - core
 - supporting

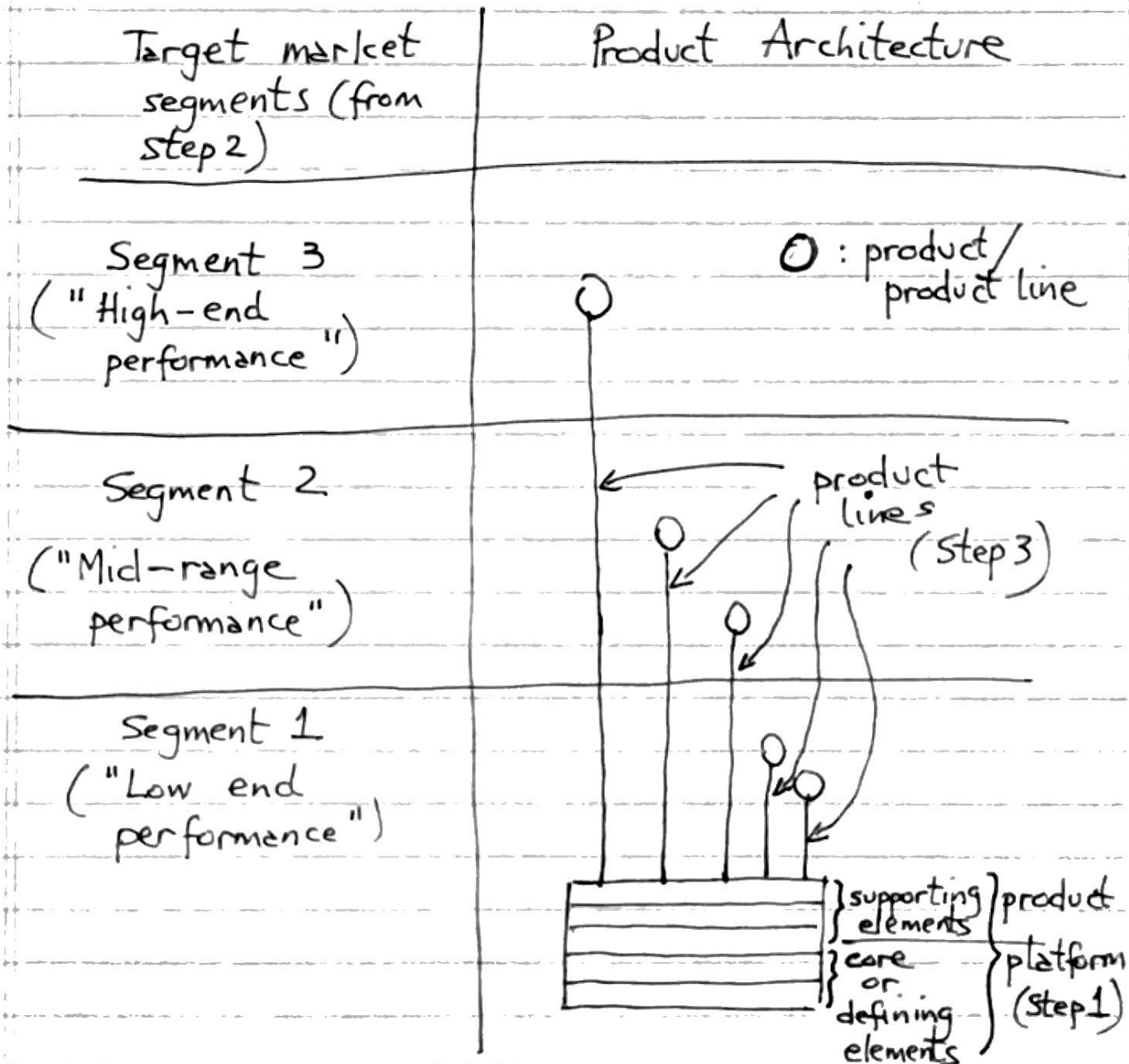
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platform product
 primary or a product
 or
 "bread & butter"

Step 2 : Determine the target market segments for the product, based on competitive strategy (and market segmentation), and prioritize these segments for the product.

Step 3 : Establish product lines to address (i.e. meet the needs of) the different market segments.

Conceptual sketch for Market Segments / Product Lines



Example : See Figure 4.1 of the "Intel/Apple product strategy" handout on Canvas

Intel 486 platform

Step 4 : For each product line create the necessary project plan to introduce each product line to its target market segment

Example : Fig 4.2 of the "Intel/Apple product strategy" handout.

Step 5 : Product Release : Introduce product lines (to their respective market segments) in a "time-phased" manner to "cover" (or reach) all the desired target market segments

Example : See Figures 4.1 & 4.2 of the "I/A...." handout